

THE LONDON BAPTIST CONFESSION OF
1689

Chapter I

Of the Holy Scriptures

1 The Holy Scripture is the only sufficient, certain, and infallible ¹Rule of all Saving Knowledge, Faith, and Obedience; Although the light ²of Nature, and the works of Creation and Providence do so far manifest the goodness, wisdom, and power of God, as to leave men inexcusable; yet are they not sufficient to give that knowledge of God and his Will, which is necessary unto Salvation. ³Therefore it pleased the Lord at sundry times, and in divers manners, to reveal himself, and to declare that his Will unto his Church; and afterward for the better preserving, and propagating of the Truth, and for the more sure Establishment, and Comfort of the Church against the corruption of the Flesh, and the malice of Satan, and of the World, to commit the same wholly unto ⁴writing; which maketh the Holy Scriptures to be most necessary, those former ways of God's revealing his Will unto his People being now ceased.

¹ 2 Timothy 3:15-17; Isaiah 8:20; Luke 16:29,31; Ephesians 2:20

² Romans 1:19-21, etc.; 2:14-15; Psalms 19:1-3

³ Hebrews 1:1

⁴ Proverbs 22:19-21; Romans 15:4; 2 Peter 1:19-20

2 Under the name of Holy Scripture, or the Word of God written, are now contained all the Books of the Old and New Testament, which are these:

Of the Old Testament Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, Deuteronomy, Joshua, Judges, Ruth, 1 Samuel, 2 Samuel, 1 Kings, 2 Kings, 1 Chronicles, 2 Chronicles, Ezra, Nehemiah, Esther, Job, Psalms, Proverbs, Ecclesiastes, The Song of Songs, Isaiah, Jeremiah, Lamentations, Ezekiel, Daniel, Hosea, Joel, Amos, Obadiah, Jonah, Micah, Nahum, Habakkuk, Zephaniah, Haggai, Zechariah, Malachi.

Of the New Testament Matthew, Mark, Luke, John, The Acts of the Apostles, Paul's Epistle to the Romans, 1 Corinthians, 2 Corinthians, Galatians, Ephesians, Philippians, Colossians, 1 Thessalonians, 2 Thessalonians, 1

Timothy, 2 Timothy, to Titus, to Philemon, the Epistle to the Hebrews, the Epistle of James, the first and second Epistles of Peter, the first, second and third Epistles of John, the Epistle of Jude, the Revelation.

All which are given by the ⁵inspiration of God, to be the Rule of Faith and Life.

⁵ 2 Timothy 3:16

3 The Books commonly called Apocrypha, not being of ⁶Divine Inspiration, are no part of the Canon (or Rule) of the Scripture, and, therefore are of no authority to the Church of God, nor to be any otherwise approved or made use of, than other Human Writings.

⁶ Luke 24:27,44; Romans 3:2

4 The Authority of the Holy Scripture, for which it ought to be believed, dependeth not upon the testimony of any Man or Church, but wholly upon ⁷God, (who is truth itself), the Author thereof; therefore it is to be received, because it is the Word of God.

⁷ 2 Peter 1:19-21; 2 Timothy 3:16; 2 Thessalonians 2:13; 1 John 5:9

5 We may be moved and induced by the testimony of the Church of God, to an high and reverent esteem of the Holy Scriptures; and the heavenliness of the Matter, the efficacy of the Doctrine, and the majesty of the Style, the consent of all the Parts, the scope of the Whole, (which is to give all glory to God) the full discovery it makes of the only Way of Man's Salvation, and many other incomparable Excellencies, and entire Perfections thereof, are Arguments whereby it doth abundantly evidence itself to be the Word of God; yet notwithstanding, our ⁸full persuasion, and assurance of the infallible Truth, and Divine Authority thereof, is from the inward work of the Holy Spirit, bearing witness by and with the Word in our Hearts.

⁸ John 16:13,14; 1 Corinthians 2:10-12; 1 John 2:20,27

6 The whole Counsel of God concerning all things ⁹necessary for his own Glory, Man's Salvation, Faith and Life, is either expressly set down or necessarily contained in the Holy Scripture; unto which nothing at any time is to be added, whether by new revelation of the Spirit, or traditions of men. Nevertheless, we acknowledge the inward ¹⁰Illumination of the Spirit of God, to be necessary for the saving understanding of such things as are revealed in the Word, and that there are some circumstances concerning the Worship of God, and Government of the Church, common to Human Actions and Societies; which are to be ¹¹ordered by the Light of Nature, and Christian Prudence, according to the general Rules of the Word, which are always to be observed.

⁹ 2 Timothy 3:15-17; Galatians 1:8-9

¹⁰ John 6:45; 1 Corinthians 2:9-12

¹¹ 1 Corinthians 11:13,14; 14:26,40

7 All things in Scripture are not alike ¹²plain in themselves, nor alike clear unto all; yet those things which are necessary to be known, believed, and observed for Salvation, are so ¹³clearly propounded, and opened in some place of Scripture or other, that not only the learned, but the unlearned, in a due use of ordinary means, may attain to a sufficient understanding of them.

¹² 2 Peter 3:16

¹³ Psalms 19:7; Psalms 119:130

8 The Old Testament in ¹⁴*Hebrew*, (which was the Native Language of the People of God of old), and the New Testament in *Greek*, (which at the time of the writing of it) was most generally known to the Nations, being immediately inspired by God, and by his singular Care and Providence kept pure in all Ages, are therefore ¹⁵authenticall; so as in all Controversies of Religion, the Church is finally to appeal unto them. ¹⁶But because these original Tongues are not known to all the People of God, who have a right unto, and interest in the Scriptures, and are commanded in the fear of God to read ¹⁷and search them, therefore they are to be translated into the vulgar Language of every Nation, unto which they ¹⁸come, that the Word of God dwelling ¹⁹plentifully in all, they may worship him in an acceptable manner, and through patience and comfort of the Scriptures may have hope.

¹⁴ Romans 3:2

¹⁵ Isaiah 8:20

¹⁶ Acts 15:15

¹⁷ John 5:39

¹⁸ 1 Corinthians 14:6,9,11,12,24,28

¹⁹ Colossians 3:16

9 The Infallible Rule of interpretation of Scripture is the ²⁰Scripture itself: And therefore when there is a question about the true and full sense of any Scripture, (which is not manifold but one) it must be searched by other places, that speak more clearly.

²⁰ 2 Peter 1:20,21; Acts 15:15,16

10 The Supreme Judge, by which all Controversies of Religion are to be determined, and all Decrees of Councils, Opinions of ancient Writers, Doctrines of Men, and private Spirits, are to be examined, and in whose sentence we are to rest, can be no other but the Holy Scripture delivered by the Spirit, into which ²¹Scripture so delivered, our Faith is finally resolved.

²¹ Matthew 22:29,31; Ephesians 2:20; Acts 28:23

Chapter II

Of God and Of the Holy Trinity

1 The Lord our God is but ¹one only living, and true God; whose ²subsistence is in and of himself, ³infinite in being and perfection, whose Essence cannot be comprehended by any but himself; ⁴a most pure Spirit, ⁵invisible, without body, parts, or passions, who only hath immortality, dwelling in the light, which no man can approach unto, who is ⁶immutable, ⁷immense, ⁸eternal, incomprehensible, ⁹Almighty, every way infinite, ¹⁰most holy, most wise, most free, most absolute, ¹¹working all things according to the counsel of his own immutable, and most righteous will, ¹²for his own glory, most loving, gracious, merciful, longsuffering, abundant in goodness and truth, forgiving iniquity, transgression and sin, ¹³the rewarder of them that diligently seek him, and withal most just, ¹⁴and terrible in his judgments, ¹⁵hating all sin, and who will by no means clear the ¹⁶guilty.

¹ 1 Corinthians 8:4,6; Deuteronomy 6:4

² Jeremiah 10:10; Isaiah 48:12

³ Exodus 3:14

⁴ John 4:24

⁵ 1 Timothy 1:17; Deuteronomy 4:15-16

⁶ Malachi 3:6

⁷ 1 Kings 8:27; Jeremiah 23:23

⁸ Psalms 90:2

⁹ Genesis 17:1

¹⁰ Isaiah 6:3

¹¹ Psalms 115:3; Isaiah 46:10

¹² Proverbs 16:4; Romans 11:36

¹³ Exodus 34:6-7; Hebrews 11:6

¹⁴ Nehemiah 9:32-33

¹⁵ Psalms 5:5-6

¹⁶ Exodus 34:7; Nahum 1:2-3

2 God, having all ¹⁷life, ¹⁸glory, ¹⁹goodness, blessedness, in and of himself, is alone in and unto himself all-sufficient, not ²⁰standing in need of any Creature which he hath made, nor deriving any glory from them, but only manifesting his own glory in, by, unto, and upon them, he is the alone Fountain of all Being, ²¹of whom, through whom, and to whom are all things, and he hath most sovereign ²²dominion over all creatures, to do by them, for them, or upon them, whatsoever himself pleaseth; in his sight ²³all things are open and manifest, his knowledge is ²⁴infinite, infallible, and independent upon the Creature, so as nothing is to him contingent or uncertain; he is most holy in all his Counsels, in ²⁵all his Works, and in all his Commands; to him is due ²⁶from Angels and Men, whatsoever worship, service, or obedience, as Creatures they owe unto the Creator, and whatever he is further pleased to require of them.

¹⁷ John 5:26

¹⁸ Psalms 148:13

¹⁹ Psalms 119:68

²⁰ Job 22:2-3

²¹ Romans 11:34-36

²² Daniel 4:25,34-35

²³ Hebrews 4:13

²⁴ Ezekiel 11:5; Acts 15:18

²⁵ Psalms 145:17

²⁶ Revelation 5:12-14

3 In this Divine and Infinite Being there are three subsistences, ²⁷the Father, the Word, (or Son), and Holy Spirit, of one substance, power, and eternity, each having the whole Divine Essence, ²⁸yet the Essence undivided, the Father is of none neither begotten nor proceeding, the Son is ²⁹eternally begotten of the Father, the Holy Spirit ³⁰proceeding from the Father and the Son, all infinite, without beginning, therefore but one God, who is not to be divided in Nature and Being, but distinguished by several peculiar, relative Properties, and personal Relations; which Doctrine of the Trinity is the Foundation of all our Communion with God, and comfortable dependence on him.

²⁷ 1 John 5:7; Matthew 28:19; 2 Corinthians 13:14

²⁸ Exodus 3:14; John 14:11; 1 Corinthians 8:6

²⁹ John 1:14,18

³⁰ John 15:26; Galatians 4:6

Chapter III

Of God's Decree

1 GOD hath ¹ *decreed* in himself, from all eternity, by the most wise and holy Counsel of his own Will, freely and unchangeably, all things whatsoever comes to pass; yet so as thereby is God neither the Author of sin, ²nor hath fellowship with any therein, nor is violence offered to the will of the Creature, nor yet is the liberty, or contingency of second

¹ Isaiah 46:10; Ephesians 1:11; Hebrews 6:17; Romans 9:15,18

² James 1:13,17; 1 John 1:5

³ Acts 4:27,28; John 19:11

⁴ Numbers 23:19; Ephesians 1:3-5

2 Although God knoweth whatsoever may, or can come to pass upon all ³supposed conditions; yet hath he not *decreed* anything, ⁴because he foresaw it as future, or as that which would come to pass upon such conditions.

⁵ Acts 15:18

⁶ Romans 9:11,13,16,18

3 By the *Decree* of God, for the manifestation of his glory, ⁵some Men and Angels are predestinated, or foreordained to Eternal Life through Jesus Christ, to the ⁶praise of his glorious grace; others being left to act in their sin to their ⁷just condemnation, to the praise of his glorious justice.

⁷ 1 Timothy 5:21; Matthew 25:41

⁸ Ephesians 1:5,6

⁹ Romans 9:22,23; Jude 4

4 These Angels and Men thus predestinated, and foreordained, are particularly, and unchangeably designed; and their ⁸number so certain and definite, that it cannot be either increased, or diminished.

¹⁰ 2 Timothy 2:19; John 13:18

5 Those of Mankind ⁹that are predestinated to life, God before the foundation of the world was laid, according to his eternal and immutable Purpose, and the secret counsel and good pleasure of his Will, hath chosen in Christ unto everlasting glory, out of his mere free grace and love, ¹⁰without any other thing in the creature as a condition or cause moving him thereunto.

¹¹ Ephesians 1:4,9,11; Romans 8:30; 2 Timothy 1:9; 1 Thessalonians 5:9

¹² Romans 9:13,16; Ephesians 1:6,12

6 As God hath appointed the elect unto glory, so he hath, by the eternal and most free purpose of his will, foreordained ¹¹all the means thereunto; wherefore they who are elected, being fallen in Adam, ¹²are redeemed by Christ, are effectually ¹³called unto faith in Christ, by his Spirit working in due season, are justified, adopted, sanctified, and kept by his power through faith ¹⁴unto salvation; neither are any other redeemed by Christ, or ¹⁵effectually called, justified, adopted, sanctified, and saved, but the elect ¹⁶only.

¹³ 1 Peter 1:2; 2 Thessalonians 2:13

¹⁴ 1 Thessalonians 5:9,10

¹⁵ Romans 8:30; 2 Thessalonians 2:13

¹⁶ 1 Peter 1:5

¹⁷ John 10:26, 17:9, 6:64

7 The Doctrine of this high mystery of predestination is to be handled with special prudence and care, that men attending the will of God revealed in his Word, and yielding obedience thereunto, may, from the certainty of their effectual vocation, be assured of their ¹⁷eternal election; so shall this doctrine afford matter ¹⁸of praise, reverence, and admiration of God, and ¹⁹of humility, diligence, and ²⁰abundant consolation to all that sincerely obey the gospel.

¹⁸ 1 Thessalonians 1:4-5; 2 Peter 1:10

¹⁹ Ephesians 1:6; Romans 11:33

²⁰ Romans 11:5,6

²¹ Luke 10:20

Chapter IV

Of Creation

1 IN the beginning it pleased God the Father, ¹Son, and Holy Spirit, for the manifestation of the glory of ²his Eternal Power, Wisdom, and Goodness, to *create* or *make* the World, and all things therein, ³whether visible or invisible, in the space of six days, and all very good.

¹ John 1:2,3; Hebrews 1:2; Job 26:13

² Romans 1:20

³ Colossians 1:16; Genesis 2:1,2

2 After God had made all other Creatures, he *created* ⁴Man, Male and Female, with ⁵reasonable and immortal Souls, rendering them fit unto that Life to God, for which they were *created*; being ⁶made after the image of God, in knowledge, righteousness, and true holiness; having the Law of God ⁷written in their hearts, and power to fulfill it; and yet under a possibility of transgressing, being left to the liberty of their own will, which was ⁸subject to change.

⁴ Genesis 1:27

⁵ Genesis 2:7

⁶ Ecclesiastes 7:29; Genesis 1:26

⁷ Romans 2:14,15

⁸ Genesis 3:6

3 Besides the Law written in their Hearts, they received ⁹a Command not to eat of the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil, which whilst they kept, they were happy in their Communion with God, and had Dominion ¹⁰over the Creatures.

⁹ Genesis 2:17

¹⁰ Genesis 1:26,28

Chapter V

Of Divine Providence

1 GOD the good *Creator* of all things, in *his* infinite power, and wisdom, doth ¹uphold, direct, dispose, and govern all Creatures, and Things, from the greatest even to the ²least, by *his* most wise and holy Providence, to the end for the which they were *created*, according unto *his* infallible foreknowledge, and the free and immutable counsel of *his* ³own Will; to the praise of the glory of *his* wisdom, power, justice, infinite goodness and mercy.

¹ Hebrews 1:3; Job 38:11; Isaiah 46:10,11; Psalms 135:6

² Matthew 10:29-31

³ Ephesians 1:11

2 Although in relation to the foreknowledge and *Decree of God*, the first cause, all things come to pass ⁴immutably and infallibly; so that there is not anything, befalls any ⁵by chance, or without *his Providence*; yet by the same *Providence* he ordereth them to fall out, according to the nature of second causes, either ⁶necessarily, freely, or contingently.

⁴ Acts 2:23

⁵ Proverbs 16:33

⁶ Genesis 8:22

3 God, in *his* ordinary *Providence* ⁷maketh use of means; yet is free ⁸to work, without, ⁹above, and ¹⁰against them at *his* pleasure.

⁷ Acts 27:31,44; Isaiah 55:10-11

⁸ Hosea 1:7

⁹ Romans 4:19-21

¹⁰ Daniel 3:27

4 The Almighty Power, unsearchable Wisdom, and infinite Goodness of *God*, so far manifest themselves in *his Providence*, that *his* determinate Counsel ¹¹extendeth itself even to the first Fall, and all other sinful Actions both of Angels and Men; (and that not by a bare permission) which also he most wisely

and powerfully ¹²boundeth, and otherwise ordereth and governeth, in a manifold dispensation to *his* most holy ¹³ends; yet so, as the sinfulness of their acts proceedeth only from the Creatures, and not from *God*, who being most holy and righteous, neither is nor can be the Author or ¹⁴Approver of sin.

¹¹ Romans 11:32-34; 2 Samuel 24:1; 1 Chronicles 21:1

¹² 2 Kings 19:28; Psalms 76:10

¹³ Genesis 50:20; Isaiah 10:6,7,12

¹⁴ Psalms 50:21; 1 John 2:16

5 The most wise, righteous, and gracious *God* doth oftentimes leave for a season *his* own children to manifold temptations, and the corruptions of their own heart, to chastise them for their former sins, or to discover unto them the hidden strength of corruption, and deceitfulness of their hearts, ¹⁵that they may be humbled; and to raise them to a more close and constant dependence for their support upon himself; and to make them more watchful against all future occasions of sin, and for other just and holy ends. So that whatsoever befalls any of his Elect is by his appointment, for his glory, ¹⁶and their good.

¹⁵ 2 Chronicles 32:25,26,31; 2 Samuel 24:1; 2 Corinthians 12:7-9

¹⁶ Romans 8:28

6 As for those wicked and ungodly men, whom God, as a righteous Judge, for former sin doth ¹⁷blind and harden; from them he not only withholdeth his ¹⁸Grace, whereby they might have been enlightened in their understanding, and wrought upon their hearts; but sometimes also withdraweth ¹⁹the gifts which they had, and exposeth them to such ²⁰objects as their *corruption* makes occasion of sin; and withal, ²¹gives them over to their own Lusts, the temptations of the World, and the power of Satan, whereby it comes to pass that they ²²harden themselves, even under those means which God useth for the softening of others.

¹⁷ Romans 1:24,26,28; 11:7,8

¹⁸ Deuteronomy 29:4

¹⁹ Matthew 13:12

²⁰ Deuteronomy 2:30; 2 Kings 8:12,13

²¹ Psalms 81:11,12; 2 Thessalonians 2:10-12

²² Exodus 8:15,32; Isaiah 6:9,10; 1 Peter 2:7,8

7 As the *Providence* of *God* doth in general reach to all *Creatures*, so after a more special manner it taketh care of his ²³*Church*, and disposeth of all things to the good thereof.

²³ 1 Timothy 4:10; Amos 9:8,9; Isaiah 43:3-5)

Chapter VI

Of the Fall of Man, of Sin, and of the Punishment Thereof

1 ALthough *God created Man* upright, and perfect, and gave him a righteous Law, which had been unto Life had he kept it, ¹and threatened Death upon the breach thereof; yet he did not long abide in this honour; ²Satan using the subtlety of the Serpent to seduce *Eve*, then by her seducing *Adam*, who without any compulsion, did willfully transgress the Law of their *Creation*, and the Command given unto them, in eating the forbidden Fruit; which *God* was pleased, according to *his* wise and holy *Counsel* to permit, having purposed to order it, to *his* own glory.

¹ Genesis 2:16,17

² Genesis 3:12,13; 2 Corinthians 11:3

2 Our first *Parents* by this *Sin*, fell from their ³original righteousness and communion with *God*, and we in them, whereby death came upon all; ⁴all becoming dead in *Sin*, and wholly defiled, ⁵in all the faculties, and parts of soul, and body.

³ Romans 3:23

⁴ Romans 5:12, etc.

⁵ Titus 1:15; Genesis 6:5; Jeremiah 17:9; Romans 3:10-19

3 They being the ⁶root, and by *God's* appointment, standing in the room, and stead of all Mankind; the guilt of the *Sin* was imputed, and *corrupted* Nature conveyed, to all their Posterity, descending from them by ordinary generation, being now ⁷conceived in *Sin*, and by nature children ⁸of Wrath, the servants of *Sin*, the subjects ⁹of *Death*, and all other miseries, spiritual, temporal and eternal, unless the *Lord Jesus* ¹⁰set them free.

⁶ Romans 5:12-19; 1 Corinthians 15:21,22,45,49

CHAPTER VI. OF THE FALL OF MAN, OF SIN, AND OF THE PUNISHMENT THEREOF¹²

⁷ Psalms 51:5; Job 14:4

⁸ Ephesians 2:3

⁹ Romans 6:20, 5:12

¹⁰ Hebrews 2:14; 1 Thessalonians 1:10

4 From this original *corruption*, whereby we are utterly ¹¹indisposed, disabled, and made opposite to all good, and wholly inclined to all evil, ¹²do proceed all actual transgressions.

¹¹ Romans 8:7; Colossians 1:21

¹² James 1:14,15; Matthew 15:19

5 The *corruption* of Nature, during this Life, doth ¹³remain in those that are regenerated: and although it be through *Christ* pardoned, and mortified, yet both itself, and the first motions thereof, are truly and properly ¹⁴*Sin*.

¹³ Romans 7:18,23; Ecclesiastes 7:20; 1 John 1:8

¹⁴ Romans 7:24,25; Galatians 5:17

Chapter VII

Of God's Covenant

1 THE distance between *God* and the *Creature* is so great, that although reasonable *Creatures* do owe obedience to him as their *Creator*, yet they could never have attained the reward of Life, but by some ¹voluntary condescension on *God's part*, which he hath been pleased to express, by way of *Covenant*.

¹ Luke 17:10; Job 35:7,8

2 Moreover, *Man* having brought himself ²under the *curse* of the Law by his fall, it pleased the *Lord* to make a *Covenant* of *Grace*, wherein he freely offereth unto *Sinners*, ³Life and Salvation by *Jesus Christ*, requiring of them Faith in him, that they may be saved; and ⁴promising to give unto all those that are ordained unto eternal *Life*, his holy *Spirit*, to make them willing, and able to believe.

² Genesis 2:17; Galatians 3:10; Romans 3:20,21

³ Romans 8:3; Mark 16:15,16; John 3:16

⁴ Ezekiel 36:26,27; John 6:44,45; Psalms 110:3

3 This *Covenant* is revealed in the Gospel; first of all to *Adam* in the promise of Salvation by the ⁵Seed of the Woman, and afterwards by farther steps, until the full ⁶discovery thereof was completed in the New Testament; and it is founded in that ⁷Eternal *Covenant* transaction, that was between the *Father* and the *Son*, about the redemption of the *Elect*; and it is alone by the Grace of this *Covenant*, that all the Posterity of fallen *Adam*, that ever were ⁸saved, did obtain Life and blessed Immortality; Man being now utterly incapable of acceptance with *God* upon those terms, on which *Adam* stood in his state of Innocency.

⁵ Genesis 3:15

⁶ Hebrews 1:1

⁷ 2 Timothy 1:9; Timothy 1:2

⁸ Hebrews 11:6,13; Romans 4:1,2,etc.; Acts 4:12; John 8:56

Chapter VIII

Of Christ the Mediator

1 IT pleased *God*, in his eternal purpose, to choose and ordain the *Lord Jesus*, his only begotten *Son*, according to the *Covenant* made between them both, ¹to be the *Mediator* between *God* and *Man*; the ²Prophet, ³Priest, and ⁴King; Head and Saviour of the Church, the Heir of all things, and Judge of the World: Unto whom he did from all eternity ⁵give a People to be his Seed, and to be by him in time redeemed, called, justified, sanctified, and glorified.

¹ Isaiah 42:1; 1 Peter 1:19,20

² Acts 3:22

³ Hebrews 5:5,6

⁴ Psalms 2:6; Luke 1:33; Ephesians 1:22-23; Hebrews 1:2; Acts 17:31

⁵ Isaiah 53:10; John 17:6; Romans 8:30

2 The *Son of God*, the second Person in the *Holy Trinity*, being very and eternal *God*, the brightness of the Father's glory, of one substance and equal with *him*: who made the World, who upholdeth and governeth all things he hath made: did, when the fullness of time was come, take upon him ⁶Man's nature, with all the essential Properties, and common Infirmities thereof, ⁷yet without Sin: being conceived by the *Holy Spirit* in the *Womb* of the *Virgin Mary*, the *Holy Spirit* coming down upon her, and the power of the *most High* overshadowing her, ⁸and so was made of a *Woman*, of the Tribe of *Judah*, of the seed of *Abraham* and *David* according to the *Scriptures*: So that two whole, perfect, and distinct Natures, were inseparably joined together in one Person, without *conversion*, *composition*, or *confusion*; which Person is very *God* and very *Man*, yet one ⁹*Christ*, the only *Mediator* between *God* and *Man*.

⁶ John 1:14; Galatians 4:4

⁷ Romans 8:3; Hebrews 2:14,16,17; 4:15

⁸ Luke 1:27,31,35

⁹ Romans 9:5; 1 Timothy 2:5

3 The *Lord Jesus*, in his Human Nature thus united to the Divine, in the Person of the *Son*, was sanctified, and anointed ¹⁰with the *Holy Spirit*, above

measure; having in him ¹¹all the treasures of Wisdom and Knowledge; in whom it pleased the *Father*, that ¹²all fullness should dwell: to the end, that being ¹³holy, harmless, undefiled, and full ¹⁴of *Grace*, and *Truth*, he might be thoroughly furnished to execute the Office of *Mediator*, and ¹⁵*Surety*; which Office he took not upon himself, but was thereunto ¹⁶called by his *Father*; who also put ¹⁷all Power and Judgement in his hand, and gave him Commandment to execute the same.

¹⁰ Psalms 45:7; Acts 10:38; John 3:34

¹¹ Colossians 2:3

¹² Colossians 1:19

¹³ Hebrews 7:26

¹⁴ John 1:14

¹⁵ Hebrews 7:22

¹⁶ Hebrews 5:5

¹⁷ John 5:22,27; Matthew 28:18; Acts 2:36

4 This Office the *Lord Jesus* did most ¹⁸willingly undertake, which that he might discharge he was made under the Law, ¹⁹and did perfectly fulfil it, and underwent the ²⁰punishment due to us, which we should have borne and suffered, being made ²¹*Sin* and a *Curse* for us: enduring most grievous sorrows ²²in his Soul; and most painful sufferings in his Body; was crucified, and died, and remained in the state of the dead, yet saw no ²³*corruption*: on the ²⁴third day he arose from the dead, with the same ²⁵body in which he suffered; with which he also ²⁶ascended into Heaven; and there sitteth at the right hand of *his Father*, ²⁷making intercession; and shall ²⁸return to judge *Men* and *Angels*, at the end of the World.

¹⁸ Psalms 40:7-8; Hebrews 10:5-11; John 10:18

¹⁹ Galatians 4:4; Matthew 3:15

²⁰ Galatians 3:13; 1 Samuel 53:6; 1 Peter 3:18

²¹ 2 Corinthians 5:21

²² Matthew 26:37,38; Luke 22:44; Matthew 27:46

²³ Acts 13:37

²⁴ 1 Corinthians 15:3,4

²⁵ John 20:25,27

²⁶ Mark 16:19; Acts 1:9-11

²⁷ Romans 8:34; Hebrews 9:24

²⁸ Acts 10:42; Romans 14:9,10; Acts 1:10

5 The *Lord Jesus*, by his perfect obedience and sacrifice of himself, which he through the Eternal *Spirit* once offered up unto *God*, ²⁹hath fully satisfied the justice of God, procured reconciliation, and purchased an Everlasting Inheritance in the Kingdom of Heaven, ³⁰for all those whom the *Father* hath given unto him.

²⁹ Hebrews 9:14, 10:14; Romans 3:25,26

³⁰ John 17:2; Hebrews 9:15

6 Although the Price of Redemption was not actually paid by *Christ* till after his *Incarnation*, ³¹yet the virtue, efficacy, and benefit thereof were communicated to the Elect in all Ages successively, from the beginning of the World, in and by those Promises, Types, and Sacrifices, wherein he was revealed, and signified to be the Seed of the *Woman*, which should bruise the Serpent's Head; ³²and the Lamb slain from the foundation of the World: ³³Being *the same yesterday, and today, and for ever*.

³¹ 1 Corinthians 10:4; Hebrews 4:2; 1 Peter 1:10,11

³² Revelation 13:8

³³ Hebrews 13:8

7 Christ in the work of *Mediation* acteth according to both Natures, by each Nature doing that which is proper to itself; yet by reason of the Unity of the Person that which is proper to one Nature, is sometimes in *Scripture* attributed to the Person ³⁴denominated by the other Nature.

³⁴ John 3:13; Acts 20:28

8 To all those for whom Christ hath obtained Eternal Redemption, he doth certainly, and effectually ³⁵apply, and communicate the same; making intercession for them; uniting them to himself by his Spirit; ³⁶revealing unto them, in and by Word, the Mystery of Salvation; persuading them to believe, and obey; ³⁷governing their Hearts by his Word and Spirit, and ³⁸overcoming all their Enemies by his Almighty Power, and Wisdom; in such manner, and ways, as are most consonant to his wonderful, and ³⁹unsearchable dispensation; and all of free, and absolute Grace, without any condition foreseen in them, to procure it.

³⁵ John 6:37; 10:15,16; 17:9; Romans 5:10

³⁶ John 17:6; Ephesians 1:9; 1 John 5:20

³⁷ Romans 8:9,14

³⁸ Psalms 110:1; 1 Corinthians 15:25,26

³⁹ John 3:8; Ephesians 1:8

9 This Office of Mediator between God and Man, is proper ⁴⁰only to Christ, who is the Prophet, Priest, and King of the Church of God; and may not be either in whole, or any part thereof, transferred from him to any other.

⁴⁰ 1 Timothy 2:5

10 This number and order of Offices is necessary; for in respect of our ⁴¹ignorance, we stand in need of his prophetic Office; and in respect of our alienation from God, ⁴²and imperfection of the best of our services, we need his Priestly Office, to reconcile us, and present us acceptable unto God: and in respect to our averseness, and utter inability to return to God, and for our rescue, and security from our spiritual adversaries, we need his Kingly Office, ⁴³to convince, subdue, draw, uphold, deliver, and preserve us to his Heavenly Kingdom.

⁴¹ John 1:18

Chapter IX

Of Free Will

1 GOD hath endued the Will of Man with that natural liberty and power of acting upon choice, that it is ¹neither forced, nor by any necessity of nature determined to do good or evil.

¹ Matthew 17:12; James 1:14; Deuteronomy 30:19

2 Man, in his state of innocency, had freedom, and power, to will, and to do, that ²which was good, and well-pleasing to God; but yet ³was mutable, so that he might fall from it.

² Ecclesiastes 7:29

³ Genesis 3:6

3 Man, by his fall into a state of sin, hath wholly lost ⁴all ability of will, to any spiritual good accompanying salvation; so as a natural man, being altogether averse from that good, ⁵and dead in sin, is not able, by his own strength, to ⁶convert himself, or to prepare himself thereunto.

⁴ Romans 5:6, 8:7

⁵ Ephesians 2:1,5

⁶ Titus 3:3-5; John 6:44

4 When God converts a sinner, and translates him into the state of Grace, ⁷he freeth him from his natural bondage under sin, and by his Grace alone, enables him ⁸freely to will, and to do that which is spiritually good; yet so as that by reason of his ⁹remaining corruptions, he doth not perfectly nor only will that which is good, but doth also will that which is evil.

⁷ Colossians 1:13; John 8:36

⁸ Philemon 2:13

⁹ Romans 7:15,18,19,21,23

5 The Will of Man is made ¹⁰perfectly, and immutably free to good alone, in the state of Glory only.

Chapter X

Of Effectual Calling

1 THose whom God hath predestinated unto Life, he is pleased in his appointed, and accepted time, ¹effectually to call, by his Word, and Spirit, out of that state of Sin, and Death, in which they are by Nature, to Grace and Salvation ²by Jesus Christ; enlightening their minds spiritually, and savingly, to ³understand the things of God; taking away their ⁴heart of stone, and giving unto them a heart of flesh; renewing their wills, and by his Almighty Power determining them ⁵to that which is good, and effectually drawing them to Jesus Christ; yet so as they come ⁶most freely, being made willing by his Grace.

¹ Romans 8:30; 11:7; Ephesians 1:10,11; 2 Thessalonians 2:13,14

² Ephesians 2:1-6

³ Acts 26:18; Ephesians 1:17,18

⁴ Ezekiel 36:26

⁵ Deuteronomy 30:6; Ezekiel 36:27; Ephesians 1:19

⁶ Psalms 110:3; Song of Solomon 1:4

2 This Effectual Call is of God's free and special Grace alone, ⁷not from any thing at all foreseen in man, nor from any power, or agency in the Creature, co-working with his special Grace, ⁸the Creature being wholly passive therein, being dead in sins and trespasses, until being quickened and renewed by the holy SpiritHoly Spirit, he is thereby enabled to answer this Call, and to embrace the Grace offered and conveyed in it, and that by no less ⁹power than that which raised up Christ from the dead.

⁷ 2 Timothy 1:9; Ephesians 2:8

⁸ 1 Corinthians 2:14; Ephesians 2:5; John 5:25

⁹ Ephesians 1:19,20

3 Elect Infants dying in infancy, are ¹⁰regenerated and saved by Christ through the Spirit; who worketh when, and where, and ¹¹how he pleaseth: so also are all Elect Persons, who are incapable of being outwardly called by the Ministry of the Word.

¹⁰ John 3:3,5,6

¹¹ John 3:8

4 Others not elected, although they may be called by the Ministry of the Word,¹² and may have some common operations of the Spirit, yet not being effectually drawn by the Father, they neither will, nor can truly¹³ come to Christ; and therefore cannot be saved: much less can men that receive not the Christian Religion¹⁴ be saved; be they never so diligent to frame their Lives according to the Light of Nature and the Law of that Religion they do profess.

¹² Matthew 22:14, 13:20,21; Hebrews 6:4,5

¹³ John 6:44,45,65; 1 John 2:24,25

¹⁴ Acts 4:12; John 4:22; 17:3

Chapter XI

Of Justification

1 Those whom God effectually calleth, he also freely ¹justifieth, not by infusing righteousness into them, but by ²pardoning their sins, and by accounting and accepting their Persons as ³righteous; not for anything wrought in them, or done by them, but for Christ's sake alone; not by imputing faith itself, the act of believing, or any other ⁴evangelical obedience to them, as their righteousness; but by imputing Christ's active obedience unto the whole Law, and passive obedience in his death, for their whole and sole righteousness, they ⁵receiving, and resting on him, and his righteousness, by Faith; which Faith they have not of themselves, it is the Gift of God.

¹ Romans 3:24, 8:30

² Romans 4:5-8; Ephesians 1:7

³ 1 Corinthians 1:30,31; Romans 5:17-19

⁴ Philemon 3:8,9; Ephesians 2:8-10

⁵ John 1:12; Romans 5:17

2 Faith thus receiving and resting on Christ, and his Righteousness, is the ⁶alone Instrument of Justification: yet it is not alone in the person justified, but is ever accompanied with all other saving Graces, and is no dead Faith, ⁷but worketh by love.

⁶ Romans 3:28

⁷ Galatians 5:6; James 2:17,22,26

3 Christ, by his obedience, and death, did fully discharge the debt of all those that are justified; and did by the sacrifice of himself, in the blood of his Cross, undergoing in their stead, the penalty due unto them, make a proper, real, and full satisfaction ⁸to God's justice in their behalf; yet, inasmuch as he was given by the Father for them, and his Obedience and Satisfaction accepted in their stead, and both ⁹freely, not for any thing in them, their Justification is only of Free Grace, that both the exact Justice and rich Grace of *God* might be ¹⁰glorified in the Justification of sinners.

⁸ Hebrews 10:14; 1 Peter 1:18,19; Isaiah 53:5,6

⁹ Romans 8:32; 2 Corinthians 5:21

¹⁰ Romans 3:26; Ephesians 1:6,7, 2:7

4 God did from all eternity decree to ¹¹justify all the Elect, and Christ did in the fullness of time die for their Sins, and rise ¹²again for their Justification; nevertheless, they are not justified personally, until the Holy Spirit doth in due time ¹³actually apply Christ unto them.

¹¹ Galatians 3:8; 1 Peter 1:2; 1 Timothy 2:6

¹² Romans 4:25

¹³ Colossians 1:21,22; Titus 3:4-7

5 God doth continue to ¹⁴forgive the sins of those that are justified, and although they can never fall from the state of ¹⁵justification, yet they may by their sins fall under God's ¹⁶fatherly displeasure; and in that condition they have not usually the light of his countenance restored unto them, until they ¹⁷humble themselves, confess their sins, beg pardon, and renew their faith and repentance.

¹⁴ Matthew 6:12; 1 John 1:7,9

¹⁵ John 10:28

¹⁶ Psalms 89:31-33

¹⁷ Psalms 32:5; Psalms 51; Matthew 26:75

6 The justification of Believers under the Old Testament, was in all these respects, ¹⁸one and the same with the justification of Believers under the New Testament.

¹⁸ Galatians 3:9; Romans 4:22-24

Chapter XII

Of Adoption

ALL those that are justified, *God* vouchsafed in, and for the sake of his only *Son Jesus Christ*, to make partakers of the Grace ¹of *Adoption*; by which they are taken into the Mumber, and enjoy the Liberties, and ²Privileges of the Children of *God*; have his ³Name put upon them, ⁴receive the *Spirit* of *Adoption*, ⁵have access to the Throne of Grace with boldness; are enabled to cry *Abba, Father*; are ⁶pitied, ⁷protected, ⁸provided for, and ⁹chastened by him as by a Father; yet never ¹⁰cast off, but sealed ¹¹to the Day of Redemption, and inherit the Promises ¹²as Heirs of Everlasting Salvation.

¹ Ephesians 1:5; Galatians 4:4,5

² John 1:12; Romans 8:17

³ 2 Corinthians 6:18; Revelation 3:12

⁴ Romans 8:15

⁵ Galatians 4:6; Ephesians 2:18

⁶ Psalms 103:13

⁷ Proverbs 14:26

⁸ 1 Peter 5:7

⁹ Hebrews 12:6

¹⁰ Isaiah 54:8,9; Lam 3:31

¹¹ Ephesians 4:30

¹² Hebrews 1:14; 6:12

Chapter XIII

Of Sanctification

1 They who are united to Christ, effectually called, and regenerated, having a new Heart, and a new Spirit created in them, through the virtue of Christ's Death and Resurrection; are also ¹farther sanctified, really, and personally, through the same virtue, ²by his Word and Spirit dwelling in them; ³the dominion of the whole body of sin is destroyed, ⁴and the several lusts thereof, are more and more weakened, and mortified; and they more and more quickened and ⁵strengthened in all saving Graces, to the ⁶practice of all true Holiness, without which no man shall see the Lord.

¹ Acts 20:32; Romans 6:5,6

² John 17:17; Ephesians 3:16-19; 1 Thessalonians 5:21-23

³ Romans 6:14

⁴ Galatians 5:24

⁵ Colossians 1:11

⁶ 2 Corinthians 7:1; Hebrews 12:14

2 This Sanctification is ⁷throughout, in the whole man, yet imperfect ⁸in this life; there abideth still some remnants of corruption in every part, whence ariseth a ⁹continual, and irreconcilable war; the Flesh lusting against the Spirit, and the Spirit against the Flesh.

⁷ 1 Thessalonians 5:23

⁸ Romans 7:18,23

⁹ Galatians 5:17; 1 Peter 2:11

3 In which war, although the remaining corruption for a time may much ¹⁰prevail, yet, through the continual supply of strength, from the *sanctifying Spirit* of *Christ*, the ¹¹regenerate part doth overcome; and so the Saints grow in Grace, perfecting Holiness in the fear of God, ¹²pressing after an Heavenly Life, in Evangelical Obedience to all the Commands which *Christ* as *Head* and *King*, in his *Word* hath prescribed to them.

¹⁰ Romans 7:23

¹¹ Romans 6:14

Chapter XIV

Of Saving Faith

1 THE Grace of *Faith*, whereby the Elect are enabled to believe to the saving of their Souls, is the work of the *Spirit* of *Christ* ¹in their Hearts, and is ordinarily wrought by the Ministry of the ²Word; by which also, and by the administration of *Baptism*, and the *Lord's Supper*, *Prayer*, and other *Means* appointed of *God*, it is increased ³and strengthened.

¹ 2 Corinthians 4:13; Ephesians 2:8

² Romans 10:14,17

³ Luke 17:5; 1 Peter 2:2; Acts 20:32

2 By this *Faith*, a Christian believeth to be true ⁴whatsoever is revealed in the *Word*, for the Authority of *God* himself; and also apprehendeth an excellency therein, ⁵above all other *Writings*; and all things in the *World*: as it bears forth the Glory of *God* in his Attributes, the Excellency of *Christ* in his Nature and Offices, and the Power and Fullness of the *Holy Spirit* in his Workings, and Operations; and so is enabled to ⁶cast his Soul upon the truth thus believed; and also acteth differently upon that which each particular passage thereof containeth; yielding obedience to the ⁷commands, trembling at the ⁸threatenings, and embracing the ⁹promises of *God*, for this life, and that which is to come: But the principal Acts of Saving Faith, have immediate relation to *Christ*, accepting, receiving, and resting upon ¹⁰him alone, for Justification, Sanctification, and Eternal Life, by virtue of the Covenant of Grace.

⁴ Acts 24:14

⁵ Psalms 19:7-10; 119:72

⁶ 2 Timothy 1:12

⁷ John 15:14

⁸ Isaiah 66:2

⁹ Hebrews 11:13

¹⁰ John 1:12; Acts 16:31; Galatians 2:20; Acts 15:11

3 This *Faith*, although it be different in degrees, and may be weak, ¹¹or strong, yet it is in the least degree of it, different in the kind, or nature of it (as is all other

Saving Grace) from the Faith ¹²and common Grace of temporary believers; and therefore, though it may be many times assailed, and weakened, yet it gets ¹³the victory, growing up in many, to the attainment of a full ¹⁴assurance through *Christ*, who is both the Author ¹⁵and Finisher of our *Faith*.

¹¹ Hebrews 5:13,14; Matthew 6:30; Romans 4:19,20

¹² 2 Peter 1:1

¹³ Ephesians 6:16; 1 John 5:4,5

¹⁴ Hebrews 6:11,12; Colossians 2:2

¹⁵ Hebrews 12:2

Chapter XV

Of Repentance unto Life and Salvation

1 SUCH of the Elect as are converted at riper years, having ¹sometime lived in the state of Nature, and therein served divers Lusts and Pleasures, God in their *Effectual Calling* giveth them Repentance unto Life.

¹ Titus 3:2-5

W hereas there is none that doth good, and sinneth ²not, and the best of men may, through the power and deceitfulness of their corruption dwelling in them, with the prevalency of temptation, fall into great sins, and provocations, God hath in the Covenant of Grace, mercifully provided that Believers so sinning, and falling, ³be renewed through Repentance unto Salvation.

² Ecclesiastes 7:20

³ Luke 22:31,32

3 This Saving Repentance is an ⁴Evangelical Grace, whereby a person, being by the *Holy Spirit* made sensible of the manifold evils of his sin, doth, by Faith in Christ, humble himself for it, with godly sorrow, detestation of it, and self-aborrencey; ⁵praying for pardon, and strength of grace, with a purpose and endeavour, by supplies of the *Spirit*, to ⁶walk before God unto all well pleasing in all things.

⁴ Zechariah 12:10; Acts 11:18

⁵ Ezekiel 36:31; 2 Corinthians 7:11

⁶ Psalms 119:6; Psalms 119:128

4 As Repentance is to be continued through the whole course of our lives, upon the account of the body of death, and the motions thereof, so it is every man's duty to repent of his ⁷particular known sins, particularly.

⁷ Luke 19:8; 1 Timothy 1:13,15

5 Such is the provision which God hath made through Christ in the Covenant of Grace, for the preservation of Believers unto Salvation, that although there is no sin so small, but it deserves ⁸damnation; yet there is no sin so great, that it shall bring damnation on them that ⁹repent; which makes the constant preaching of Repentance necessary.

⁸ Romans 6:23

⁹ Isaiah 1:16,18, 55:7

Chapter XVI

Of Good Works

1 Good Works are only such as God hath ¹commanded in his Holy Word, and not such as without the warrant thereof, are devised by men, out of blind zeal, ²or upon any pretence of good intentions.

¹ Micah 6:8; Hebrews 13:21

² Matthew 15:9; Isaiah 29:13

2 These good works, done in obedience to God's commandments, are the Fruits and Evidences ³of a true and lively Faith; and by them Believers manifest their ⁴Thankfulness, strengthen their ⁵Assurance, edify their ⁶Brethren, adorn the Profession of the Gospel, stop the Mouths of the Adversaries, and glorify ⁷God, whose Workmanship they are, created in Christ Jesus ⁸thereunto, that having their Fruit unto Holiness, they may have the end ⁹Eternal Life.

³ James 2:18,22

⁴ Psalms 116:12,13

⁵ 1 John 2:3,5; 2 Peter 1:5-11

⁶ Matthew 5:16

⁷ 1 Timothy 6:1; 1 Peter 2:15; Philemon 1:11

⁸ Ephesians 2:10

⁹ Romans 6:22

3 Their ability to do good works, is not at all of themselves, but wholly from the Spirit ¹⁰of Christ; and that they may be enabled thereunto, besides the Graces they have already received, there is necessary an ¹¹actual influence of the same Holy Spirit, to work in them to will, and to do, of his good pleasure; yet they are not hereupon to grow negligent, as if they were not bound to perform any Duty, unless upon a special motion of the Spirit, but they ought to be diligent in ¹²stirring up the Grace of God that is in them.

¹⁰ John 15:4,6

¹¹ 2 Corinthians 3:5; Philemon 2:13

¹² Philemon 2:12; Hebrews 6:11,12; Isaiah 64:7

4 They who in their obedience attain to the greatest height which is possible in this life, are so far from being able to supererogate, and to do more than God requires, as that ¹³they fall short of much which in duty they are bound to do.

¹³ Job 9:2,3; Galatians 5:17; Luke 17:10

5 We cannot by our best works merit pardon of Sin or Eternal Life at the hand of God, by reason of the great disproportion that is between them and the glory to come, and the infinite distance that is between us and God, whom by them we can neither profit, nor satisfy, for the debt of our ¹⁴former sins; but when we have done all we can, we have done but our duty, and are unprofitable servants; and because as they are good they proceed from his ¹⁵Spirit, and as they are wrought by us they are defiled ¹⁶and mixed with so much weakness and imperfection, that they cannot endure the severity of God's judgement.

¹⁴ Romans 3:20; Ephesians 2:8,9; Romans 4:6

¹⁵ Galatians 5:22,23

¹⁶ Isaiah 64:6; Psalms 143:2

6 Yet notwithstanding the persons of Believers being accepted through Christ their good works also are accepted in ¹⁷him; not as though they were in this life wholly unblameable and unprovable in God's sight, but that he looking upon them in his Son, is pleased to accept and reward that which is ¹⁸sincere, although accompanied with many weaknesses and imperfections.

¹⁷ Ephesians 1:6; 1 Peter 2:5

¹⁸ Matthew 25:21,23; Hebrews 6:10

7 Works done by unregenerate men, although for the matter of them they may be things which God commands, and of good use both to themselves and ¹⁹others; yet because they proceed not from a heart purified by ²⁰Faith, nor are done in a right manner according to the ²¹Word, nor to a right end the ²²glory of God, they are therefore sinful and cannot please God, nor make a man meet to receive Grace from ²³God; and yet their neglect of them is more sinful and ²⁴displeasing to God.

¹⁹ 2 Kings 10:30; 1 Kings 21:27,29

²⁰ Genesis 4:5; Hebrews 11:4,6

²¹ 1 Corinthians 13:1

²² Matthew 6:2,5

²³ Amos 5:21,22; Romans 9:16; Timothy 3:5

²⁴ Job 21:14,15; Matthew 25:41-43

Chapter XVII

Of Perseverance of the Saints

1 THOSE whom God hath accepted in the Beloved, effectually called and sanctified by his Spirit, and given the precious Faith of his Elect unto, can neither totally nor finally fall from the state of Grace, ¹but shall certainly persevere therein to the end and be eternally saved, seeing the Gifts and Callings of God are without Repentance, (whence he still begets and nourisheth in them Faith, Repentance, Love, Joy, Hope, and all the Graces of the Spirit unto immortality) and though many storms and floods arise and beat against them, yet they shall never be able to take them off that Foundation and Rock which by Faith they are fastened upon: notwithstanding, through unbelief and the temptations of Satan, the sensible sight of the light and love of God, may for a time be clouded and obscured from ²them, yet he is still the same, ³and they shall be sure to be kept by the Power of God unto Salvation, where they shall enjoy their purchased Possession, they being engraven upon the Palm of his Hands, and their Names having been written in the Book of Life from all Eternity.

¹ John 10:28,29; Philemon 1:6; 2 Timothy 2:19; 1 John 2:19

² Psalms 89:31,32; 1 Corinthians 11:32

³ Malachi 3:6

2 This Perseverance of the Saints depends not upon their own free Will, but upon the immutability of the Decree of ⁴ Election, flowing from the free and unchangeable Love of God the Father, upon the efficacy of the Merit and Intercession of Jesus Christ ⁵and Union with him, the ⁶Oath of God, the abiding of his Spirit, and the ⁷Seed of God within them, and the Nature of the ⁸Covenant of Grace; from all which ariseth also the certainty and infallibility thereof.

⁴ Romans 8:30; 9:11,16

⁵ Romans 5:9,10; John 14:19

⁶ Hebrews 6:17,18

⁷ 1 John 3:9

⁸ Jeremiah 32:40

3 And though they may, through the temptation of Satan and of the World, the prevalency of Corruption remaining in them, and the neglect of Means of their preservation, fall into grievous ⁹Sins, and for a time continue therein; whereby they incur ¹⁰God's displeasure, and grieve his holy SpiritHoly Spirit, come to have their Graces and ¹¹Comforts impaired, have their Hearts hardened, and their Consciences wounded, ¹²hurt, and scandalize others, and bring temporal Judgments ¹³upon themselves, yet shall they renew their ¹⁴repentance and be preserved, through faith in Christ Jesus, to the end.

⁹ Matthew 26:70,72,74

¹⁰ Isaiah 64:5,9; Ephesians 4:30

¹¹ Psalms 51:10,12

¹² Psalms 32:3,4

¹³ 2 Samuel 12:14

¹⁴ Luke 22:32,61,62

Chapter XVIII

Of the Assurance of Grace and Salvation

1 ALthough temporary Believers, and other unregenerate men, may vainly deceive themselves with false hopes, and carnal presumptions, of being in the favour of God, and state of Salvation, ¹which hope of theirs shall perish; yet such as truly believe in the Lord Jesus, and love him in sincerity, endeavouring to walk in all good Conscience before him, may in this life be certainly assured, ²that they are in the state of Grace; and may rejoice in the hope of the glory of God, which hope shall never make them ³ashamed.

¹ Job 8:13,14; Matthew 7:22,23

² 1 John 2:3; 3:14,18,19,21,24; 5:13

³ Romans 5:2,5

2 This Certainty is not a bare conjectural and probable Persuasion, grounded upon ⁴a fallible Hope, but an infallible Assurance of Faith, founded on the Blood and Righteousness of Christ ⁵revealed in the Gospel; and also upon the inward ⁶evidence of those Graces of the Spirit unto which Promises are made, and on the Testimony of the ⁷Spirit of Adoption, witnessing with our Spirits that we are the Children of God; and, as a Fruit thereof, keeping the Heart both ⁸humble and holy.

⁴ Hebrews 6:11,19

⁵ Hebrews 6:17,18

⁶ 2 Peter 1:4,5,10,11

⁷ Romans 8:15,16

⁸ 1 John 3:1-3

3 This infallible Assurance doth not so belong to the Essence of Faith, but that a true Believer may wait long, and conflict with many difficulties, before he be ⁹partaker of it; yet being enabled by the Spirit to know the things which are freely given him of God, he may without extraordinary revelation in the right

use of means ¹⁰attain thereunto: and therefore it is the duty of every one, to give all diligence to make his Calling and Election sure, that thereby his Heart may be enlarged in peace and joy in the Holy Spirit, in love and thankfulness to God, and in strength and cheerfulness in the Duties of Obedience, the proper ¹¹Fruits of this Assurance; so far is it ¹²from inclining Men to looseness.

⁹ Isaiah 50:10; Psalms 88; 77:1-12

¹⁰ 1 John 4:13; Hebrews 6:11,12

¹¹ Romans 5:1,2,5; 14:17; Psalms 119:32

¹² Romans 6:1,2; Timothy 2:11,12,14

4 True Believers may have the Assurance of their Salvation divers ways shaken, diminished, and intermitted; as ¹³by negligence in preserving of it, by ¹⁴falling into some special Sin, which woundeth the Conscience, and grieveth the Spirit, by some sudden or ¹⁵vehement Temptation, by God's withdrawing the ¹⁶Light of his Countenance and suffering even such as fear him to walk in darkness and to have no light, yet are they never destitute of the ¹⁷Seed of God, and Life ¹⁸of Faith, that Love of Christ, and the Brethren, that sincerity of Heart and Conscience of Duty, out of which, by the Operation of the Spirit, this Assurance may in due time be ¹⁹revived, and by the which in the mean time they are ²⁰preserved from utter despair.

¹³ Song of Solomon 5:2-3,6

¹⁴ Psalms 51:8,12,14

¹⁵ Psalms 116:11; 77:7,8; 31:22

¹⁶ Psalms 30:7

¹⁷ 1 John 3:9

¹⁸ Luke 22:32

¹⁹ Psalms 42:5,11

²⁰ Lam 3:26,27-31

Chapter XIX

Of the Law of God

1 GOD gave to *Adam* a Law of Universal Obedience, ¹written in his Heart, and a particular Precept of not eating the Fruit of the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil; by which he bound him, and all his Posterity to personal, entire, exact, and perpetual ²Obedience; promised Life upon the fulfilling, and ³threatened Death upon the breach of it, and endued him with power and ability to keep it.

¹ Genesis 1:27; Ecclesiastes 7:29

² Romans 10:5

³ Galatians 3:10,12

2 The same Law that was first written in the Heart of Man, ⁴continued to be a perfect Rule of Righteousness after the fall, and was delivered by God upon Mount *Sinai*, in ⁵Ten Commandments, and written in two Tables, the four first containing our Duty towards God, and the other six our Duty to Man.

⁴ Romans 2:14,15

⁵ Deuteronomy 10:4

3 Besides this law, commonly called Moral, God was pleased to give to the People of *Israel* Ceremonial Laws, containing several typical Ordinances, partly of Worship, ⁶prefiguring Christ, his Graces, Actions, Sufferings, and Benefits; and partly holding forth divers Instructions ⁷of Moral Duties, all which Ceremonial Laws being appointed only to the time of reformation, are, by Jesus Christ the true Messiah and only Law-giver, who was furnished with power from the Father for that end, ⁸abrogated and taken away.

⁶ Hebrews 10:1; Colossians 2:17

⁷ 1 Corinthians 5:7

⁸ Colossians 2:14,16,17; Ephesians 2:14,16

4 To them also he gave sundry Judicial Laws, which expired together with the state of that People, not obliging any now by virtue of that Institution; their general ⁹Equity only being of moral use.

⁹ 1 Corinthians 9:8-10

5 The Moral Law doth for ever bind all, ¹⁰as well justified persons as others, to the obedience thereof, and that not only in regard of the Matter contained in it, but also in respect of the ¹¹Authority of God the Creator, who gave it; neither doth *Christ* in the Gospel any way dissolve, ¹²but much strengthen this Obligation.

¹⁰ Romans 13:8-10; James 2:8,10-12

¹¹ James 2:10,11

¹² Matthew 5:17-19; Romans 3:31

6 Although true Believers be not under the Law, as a Covenant of Works, ¹³to be thereby justified or condemned, yet it is of great use to them, as well as to others, in that, as a Rule of Life, informing them of the Will of God, and their Duty, it directs and binds them to walk accordingly; ¹⁴discovering also the sinful Pollutions of their Natures, Hearts and Lives, so as examining themselves thereby, they may come to further conviction of, humiliation for, and hatred against Sin; together with a clearer sight of the need they have of Christ and the perfection of his Obedience: It is likewise of use to the Regenerate to restrain their Corruptions, in that it forbids Sin; and the Threatenings of it serve to shew what even their Sins deserve, and what Afflictions in this Life they may expect for them, although freed from the Curse and unallayed rigour thereof. The Promises of it likewise shew them God's approbation of Obedience, and what Blessings they may expect upon the performance thereof, though not as due to them by the Law as a Covenant of Works; so as Man's doing Good and refraining from Evil, because the Law encourageth to the one and deterreth from the other, is no Evidence of his being ¹⁵under the Law and not under Grace.

¹³ Romans 6:14; Galatians 2:16; Romans 8:1; 10:4

¹⁴ Romans 3:20; 7:7; etc.

¹⁵ Romans 6:12-14; 1 Peter 3:8-13

7 Neither are the aforementioned Uses of the Law ¹⁶contrary to the Grace of the Gospel, but do sweetly comply with it, the *Spirit* of *Christ* subduing ¹⁷and enabling the Will of Man to do that freely and cheerfully which the Will of God revealed in the Law, requireth to be done.

¹⁶ Galatians 3:21

¹⁷ Ezekiel 36:27

Chapter XX

Of the Gospel, and of the Extent of the Grace thereof

1 THE Covenant of Works being broken by Sin, and made unprofitable unto Life, God was pleased to give forth the Promise of *Christ*, ¹the Seed of the Woman, as the means of calling the Elect, and begetting in them Faith and Repentance; in this Promise, the ²Gospel, as to the substance of it, was revealed, and therein effectual, for the Conversion and Salvation of Sinners.

¹ Genesis 3:15

² Revelation 13:8

2 This Promise of *Christ*, and Salvation by him, is revealed only by ³the Word of God; neither do the Works of Creation, or Providence, with the Light of Nature, ⁴make discovery of Christ, or of Grace by him, so much as in a general, or obscure way; much less, that Men, destitute of the Revelation of Him by the Promise, or Gospel, ⁵should be enabled thereby, to attain saving Faith, or Repentance.

³ Romans 1:17

⁴ Romans 10:14,15,17

⁵ Proverbs 29:18; Isaiah 25:7; 60:2,3

3 The Revelation of the Gospel unto Sinners, made in divers times, and by sundry parts, with the addition of Promises, and Precepts, for the Obedience required therein, as to the Nations, and Persons, to whom it is granted, is merely of the ⁶Sovereign Will and good Pleasure of God; not being annexed by virtue of any Promise, to the due improvement of Mens natural abilities, by virtue of common light received, without it; which none ever did ⁷make, or can do so: and therefore in all Ages the Preaching of the Gospel hath been granted unto Persons and Nations, as to the extent, or straitening of it, in great variety, according to the Counsel of the Will of God.

⁶ Psalms 147:20; Acts 16:7

⁷ Romans 1:18-32

4 Although the Gospel be the only outward means, of revealing Christ, and saving Grace, and is, as such, abundantly sufficient thereunto; yet that Men, who are dead in Trespases, may be Born again, Quickened or Regenerated, there is moreover necessary, an effectual insuperable ⁸Work of the *Holy Spirit*, upon the whole Soul, for the producing in them a new Spiritual Life; without which no other means will effect ⁹their Conversion unto God.

⁸ Psalms 110:3; 1 Corinthians 2:14; Ephesians 1:19,20

⁹ John 6:44; 2 Corinthians 4:4,6

Chapter XXI

Of Christian Liberty, and Liberty of Conscience

1 THE Liberty which *Christ* hath purchased for Believers under the Gospel, consists in their freedom from the guilt of Sin, the condemning Wrath of God, the Rigour and ¹Curse of the Law, and in their being delivered from this present evil ²World, Bondage to ³Satan, and Dominion ⁴of Sin, from the ⁵Evil of Afflictions, the Fear, and Sting ⁶of Death, the Victory of the Grave, and ⁷Everlasting Damnation; as also in their ⁸free access to God, and their yielding Obedience unto him not out of a slavish fear, ⁹but a Child-like love, and willing mind. All which were common also to Believers under the Law ¹⁰for the substance of them; but under the New Testament, the Liberty of Christians is further enlarged in their freedom from the yoke of the Ceremonial Law, to which the *Jewish* Church was subjected, and in greater boldness of access to the Throne of Grace, and in fuller Communications of the ¹¹Free Spirit of God, than Believers under the Law did ordinarily partake of.

¹ Galatians 3:13

² Galatians 1:4

³ Acts 26:18

⁴ Romans 8:3

⁵ Romans 8:28

⁶ 1 Corinthians 15:54-57

⁷ 2 Thessalonians 1:10

⁸ Romans 8:15

⁹ Luke 1:74-75; 1 John 4:18

¹⁰ Galatians 3:9,14

¹¹ John 7:38,39; Hebrews 10:19-21

2 God alone is ¹²Lord of the Conscience, and hath left it free from the Doctrines and Commandments of Men, ¹³which are in any thing contrary to his Word, or not contained in it. So that to Believe such Doctrines, or Obey such

Commands out of Conscience, ¹⁴is to betray true liberty of Conscience; and the requiring of an ¹⁵implicit Faith, and absolute and blind Obedience, is to destroy Liberty of Conscience, and Reason also.

¹² James 4:12; Romans 14:4

¹³ Acts 4:19; 5:29; 1 Corinthians 7:23; Matthew 15:9

¹⁴ Colossians 2:20,22,23

¹⁵ 1 Corinthians 3:5; 2 Corinthians 1:24

3 They who, upon pretence of Christian Liberty, do practice any Sin, or cherish any sinful Lust, as they do thereby pervert the main design of the Grace of the Gospel, ¹⁶to their own Destruction, so they wholly destroy ¹⁷the end of Christian Liberty; which is, that, being delivered out of the hands of all our Enemies, we might serve the Lord without fear, in Holiness and Righteousness before him, all the days of our Life.

¹⁶ Romans 6:1,2

¹⁷ Galatians 5:13; 2 Peter 2:18,21

Chapter XXII

Of Religious Worship, and the Sabbath-Day

1 THE Light of Nature shews that there is a God, who hath Lordship and Sovereignty over all; is just, good, and doth good unto all; and is therefore to be feared, loved, praised, called upon, trusted in, and served, with all the Heart, and all the Soul, ¹and with all the Might. But the acceptable way of Worshipping the true God, is ²instituted by himself, and so limited by his own revealed Will, that he may not be Worshipped according to the Imagination and Devices of Men, or the Suggestions of Satan, under any visible representations, or ³any other way, not prescribed in the Holy Scriptures.

¹ Jeremiah 10:7; Mark 12:33

² Deuteronomy 12:32

³ Exodus 20:4-6

2 *Religious worship* is to be given to *God the Father, Son, and Holy Spirit*, and to him ⁴alone; not to *Angels, Saints*, or any other ⁵*Creatures*; and since the Fall, not without a ⁶*Mediator*, nor in the *Mediation* of any other but ⁷Christ alone.

⁴ Matthew 4:9,10; John 4:23; Matthew 28:19

⁵ Romans 1:25; Colossians 2:18; Revelation 19:10

⁶ John 14:6

⁷ 1 Timothy 2:5

3 Prayer, with Thanksgiving, being one special part of Natural Worship, is by God required of ⁸all Men. But that it may be accepted, it is to be made in the ⁹Name of the Son, by the help ¹⁰of the Spirit, according to ¹¹his Will; with Understanding, Reverence, Humility, Fervency, Faith, Love, and Perseverance; and when with others, in a ¹²Known Tongue.

⁸ Psalms 95:1-7; 65:2

⁹ John 14:13,14

CHAPTER XXII. OF RELIGIOUS WORSHIP, AND THE SABBATH-DAY⁴⁴

¹⁰ Romans 8:26

¹¹ 1 John 5:14

¹² 1 Corinthians 14:16,17

4 Prayer is to be made for Things lawful, and for all sorts of Men living, ¹³or that shall live hereafter; but not ¹⁴for the dead, nor for those of whom it may be known, that they have sinned ¹⁵the sin unto death.

¹³ 1 Timothy 2:1,2; 2 Samuel 7:29

¹⁴ 2 Samuel 12:21-23

¹⁵ 1 John 5:16

5 The ¹⁶Reading of the Scriptures, Preaching, and ¹⁷Hearing the Word of God, Teaching and Admonishing one another in Psalms, Hymns, and Spiritual Songs, Singing with Grace in our Hearts to ¹⁸the Lord; as also the Administration ¹⁹of Baptism, and ²⁰the Lord's Supper, are all parts of Religious Worship of God, to be performed in obedience to him, with Understanding, Faith, Reverence, and Godly Fear; moreover, Solemn Humiliation, ²¹with Fastings, and Thanksgivings, upon ²²special occasions, ought to be used in an holy and religious manner.

¹⁶ 1 Timothy 4:13

¹⁷ 2 Timothy 4:2; Luke 8:18

¹⁸ Colossians 3:16; Ephesians 5:19

¹⁹ Matthew 28:19,20

²⁰ 1 Corinthians 11:26

²¹ Ester 4:16; Joel 2:12

²² Exodus 15:1 etc., Psalms 107

6 Neither Prayer nor any other part of Religious Worship, is now, under the Gospel, tied unto, or made more acceptable, by any place in which it is ²³performed, or towards which it is directed; but God is to be worshipped everywhere in Spirit, and in Truth; as in ²⁴private Families ²⁵daily, and ²⁶in secret each one by himself, so more solemnly in the public Assemblies, which are not carelessly, nor wilfully, to be ²⁷neglected, or forsaken, when God by his Word or Providence calleth thereunto.

²³ John 4:21; Malachi 1:11; 1 Timothy 2:8

²⁴ Acts 10:2

²⁵ Matthew 6:11; Psalms 55:17

²⁶ Matthew 6:6

²⁷ Hebrews 10:25; Acts 2:42

7 As it is the Law of Nature, that in general, a proportion of time, by God's appointment, be set apart for the Worship of God, so by his Word, in a positive, moral, and perpetual Commandment, binding all Men, in all Ages, he hath particularly appointed one day in seven for a ²⁸Sabbath to be kept holy unto him, which from the beginning of the World, to the resurrection of Christ, was the last day of the Week; and from the resurrection of Christ, was changed

into the first day of the Week, ²⁹which is called the Lord's Day; and is to be continued to the end of the World, as the Christian Sabbath; the observation of the last day of the Week being abolished.

²⁸ Exodus 20:8

²⁹ 1 Corinthians 16:1,2; Acts 20:7; Revelation 1:10

8 The Sabbath is then kept holy unto the Lord, when men, after a due preparing of their hearts, and ordering their common affairs aforehand, do not only observe an holy ³⁰rest all day, from their own works, words, and thoughts, about their worldly employment and recreations, but are also taken up the whole time in the public and private Exercises of his Worship, and in the Duties ³¹of Necessity and Mercy.

³⁰ Isaiah 58:13; Nehemiah 13:15-23

³¹ Matthew 12:1-13

Chapter XXIII

Of Lawful Oaths and Vows

1 A lawful oath is a part of religious worship, ¹wherein the person swearing in truth, righteousness, and judgement, solemnly calleth God to witness what he sweareth, ²and to judge him according to the truth or falseness thereof.

¹ Exodus 20:7; Deuteronomy 10:20; Jeremiah 4:2

² 2 Chronicles 6:22-23

2 The name of God only is that by which men ought to swear; and therein it is to be used, with all holy fear and reverence; therefore to swear vainly or rashly by that glorious and dreadful name, or to swear at all by any other thing, is sinful, and to be ³abhorred; yet as in matter of weight and moment, for confirmation of truth, ⁴and ending all strife, an oath is warranted by the Word of God; so a lawful oath being imposed ⁵by lawful authority in such matters, ought to be taken.

³ Matthew 5:34,37; James 5:12

⁴ Hebrews 6:16, 2 Corinthians 1:23

⁵ Nehemiah 13:25

3 Whosoever taketh an oath warranted by the Word of God, ought duly to consider the weightiness of so solemn an act, and therein to avouch nothing but what he knoweth to be truth; for that by rash, false, and vain oaths, the ⁶Lord is provoked, and for them this land mourns.

⁶ Leviticus 19:12; Jeremiah 23:10

4 An oath is to be taken in the plain and ⁷common sense of the words, without equivocation or mental reservation.

⁷ Psalms 24:4

5 A vow, which is not to be made to any creature, but to God alone, ⁸is to be made and performed with all religious care and faithfulness; but popish monastical vows ⁹of perpetual single life, professed ¹⁰poverty, and regular obedience,

are so far from being degrees of higher perfection, that they are superstitious¹¹ and sinful snares, in which no Christian may entangle himself.

⁸ Psalms 76:11; Genesis 28:20-22

⁹ 1 Corinthians 7:2,9

¹⁰ Ephesians 4:28

¹¹ Matthew 19:11

Chapter XXIV

Of the Civil Magistrate

1 God, the supreme Lord and King of all the world, hath ordained civil ¹magistrates to be under him, over the people, for his own glory and the public good; and to this end hath armed them with the power of the sword, for defence and encouragement of them that do good, and for the punishment of evil doers.

¹ Romans 13:1-4

2 It is lawful for Christians to accept and execute the office of a magistrate when called there unto; in the management whereof, as they ought especially to maintain ²justice and peace, according to the wholesome laws of each kingdom and commonwealth, so for that end they may lawfully now, under the New Testament ³wage war upon just and necessary occasions.

² 2 Samuel 23:3; Psalms 82:3-4

³ Luke 3:14

3 Civil magistrates being set up by God for the ends aforesaid; subjection, in all lawful things commanded by them, ought to be yielded by us in the Lord, not only for wrath, ⁴but for conscience sake; and we ought to make supplications and prayers for kings and all that are in authority, ⁵that under them we may live a quiet and peaceable life, in all godliness and honesty.

⁴ Romans 13:5-7; 1 Peter 2:17

⁵ 1 Timothy 2:1-2

Chapter XXV

Of Marriage

1 Marriage is to be between one man and one woman; ¹neither is it lawful for any man to have more than one wife, nor for any woman to have more than one husband at the same time.

¹ Genesis 2:24; Malachi 2:15; Matthew 19:5-6

2 Marriage was ordained for the mutual help ²of husband and wife, ³for the increase of mankind with a legitimate issue, and the ⁴preventing of uncleanness.

² Genesis 2:18

³ Genesis 1:28

⁴ 1 Corinthians 7:2,9

3 It is lawful for ⁵all sorts of people to marry, who are able with judgment to give their consent; yet it is the duty of Christians ⁶to marry in the Lord; and therefore such as profess the true religion, should not marry with infidels, ⁷or idolaters; neither should such as are godly, be unequally yoked, by marrying with such as are wicked in their life, or maintain damnable heresy.

⁵ Hebrews 13:4; 1 Timothy 4:3

⁶ 1 Corinthians 7:39

⁷ Nehemiah 13:25-27

4 Marriage ought not to be within the degrees of consanguinity ⁸or affinity, forbidden in the Word; nor can such incestuous marriages ever be made lawful, by any law of man or consent of parties, ⁹so as those persons may live together as man and wife.

⁸ Leviticus 18

⁹ Mark 6:18; 1 Corinthians 5:1

Chapter XXVI

Of the Church

1 The catholic or universal church, which (with respect to the internal work of the Spirit and truth of grace) may be called invisible, consists of the whole ¹number of the elect, that have been, are, or shall be gathered into one, under Christ, the head thereof; and is the spouse, the body, the fulness of him that filleth all in all.

¹ Hebrews 12:23; Colossians 1:18; Ephesians 1:10,22-23; 5:23,27,32

2 All persons throughout the world, professing the faith of the gospel, and obedience unto God by Christ according unto it, not destroying their own profession by any errors everting the foundation, or unholiness of conversation, ²are and may be called visible saints; ³and of such ought all particular congregations to be constituted.

² 1 Corinthians 1:2; Acts 11:26

³ Romans 1:7; Ephesians 1:20-22

3 The purest churches under heaven are subject ⁴to mixture and error; and some have so degenerated as to become ⁵no churches of Christ, but synagogues of Satan; nevertheless Christ always hath had, and ever shall have a ⁶kingdom in this world, to the end thereof, of such as believe in him, and make profession of his name.

⁴ 1 Corinthians 5; Revelation 2-3

⁵ Revelation 18:2; 2 Thessalonians 2:11-12

⁶ Matthew 16:18; Psalms 72:17; 102:28; Revelation 12:17

4 The Lord Jesus Christ is the Head of the church, in whom, by the appointment of the Father, ⁷all power for the calling, institution, order or government of the church, is invested in a supreme and sovereign manner; neither can the Pope of Rome in any sense be head thereof, but is ⁸that antichrist, that man of sin, and son of perdition, that exalteth himself in the church against Christ,

and all that is called God; whom the Lord shall destroy with the brightness of his coming.

⁷ Colossians 1:18; Matthew 28:18-20; Ephesians 4:11-12

⁸ 2 Thessalonians 2:2-9

5 In the execution of this power wherewith he is so intrusted, the Lord Jesus calleth out of the world unto himself, through the ministry of his Word, by his Spirit, ⁹those that are given unto him by his Father, that they may walk before him in all the ¹⁰ways of obedience, which he prescribeth to them in his Word. Those thus called, he commandeth to walk together in particular societies, or ¹¹churches, for their mutual edification, and the due performance of that public worship, which he requireth of them in the world.

⁹ John 10:16

¹⁰ John 12:32; Matthew 28:20

¹¹ Matthew 18:15-20

6 The members of these churches are ¹²saints by calling, visibly manifesting and evidencing (in and by their profession and walking) their obedience unto that call of Christ; and do willingly consent to walk together, according to the appointment of Christ; giving up themselves to the Lord, and one to another, by the will of God, ¹³in professed subjection to the ordinances of the Gospel.

¹² Romans 1:7; 1 Corinthians 1:2

¹³ Acts 2:41-42; 5:13-14; 2 Corinthians 9:13

7 To each of these churches thus gathered, according to his mind declared in his Word, he hath given all that ¹⁴power and authority, which is in any way needful for their carrying on that order in worship and discipline, which he hath instituted for them to observe; with commands and rules for the due and right exerting, and executing of that power.

¹⁴ Matthew 18:17-18; 1 Corinthians 5:4-5; 5:13; 2 Corinthians 2:6-8

8 A particular church, gathered and completely organized according to the mind of Christ, consists of officers and members; and the officers appointed by Christ to be chosen and set apart by the church (so called and gathered), for the peculiar administration of ordinances, and execution of power or duty, which he intrusts them with, or calls them to, to be continued to the end of the world, are ¹⁵bishops or elders, and deacons. frtfrtfrfrtfrtffdrfr45ggt4rft3m

¹⁵ Acts 20:17,28; Philemon 1:1

9 The way appointed by Christ for the calling of any person, fitted and gifted by the Holy Spirit, unto the office of bishop or elder in a church, is, that he be chosen thereunto by the common ¹⁶suffrage of the church itself; and solemnly set apart by fasting and prayer, with imposition of hands of the ¹⁷eldership of the church, if there be any before constituted therein; and of a deacon ¹⁸that he be

chosen by the like suffrage, and set apart by prayer, and the like imposition of hands.

¹⁶ Acts 14:23

¹⁷ 1 Timothy 4:14

¹⁸ Acts 6:3,5-6

10 The work of pastors being constantly to attend the service of Christ, in his churches, in the ministry of the Word and prayer, ¹⁹with watching for their souls, as they that must give an account to him; it is incumbent on the churches to whom they minister, not only to give them all due respect, ²⁰but also to communicate to them of all their good things according to their ability, so as they may have a comfortable supply, without being themselves ²¹entangled in secular affairs; and may also be capable of exercising ²²hospitality towards others; and this is required by the ²³law of nature, and by the express order of our Lord Jesus, who hath ordained that they that preach the gospel should live of the gospel.

¹⁹ Acts 6:4; Hebrews 13:17

²⁰ 1 Timothy 5:17-18; Galatians 6:6-7

²¹ 2 Timothy 2:4

²² 1 Timothy 3:2

²³ 1 Corinthians 9:6-14

11 Although it be incumbent on the bishops or pastors of the churches, to be instant in preaching the Word, by way of office, yet the work of preaching the Word is not so peculiarly confined to them but that others also ²⁴gifted and fitted by the Holy Spirit for it, and approved and called by the church, may and ought to perform it.

²⁴ Acts 11:19-21; 1 Peter 4:10-11

12 As all believers are bound to join themselves to particular churches, when and where they have opportunity so to do; so all that are admitted unto the privileges of a church, are also ²⁵under the censures and government thereof, according to the rule of Christ.

²⁵ 1 Thessalonians 5:14; 2 Thessalonians 3:6,14-15

13 No church members, upon any offence taken by them, having performed their duty required of them towards the person they are offended at, ought to disturb any churchorder, or absent themselves from the assemblies of the church, or administration of any ordinances, upon the account of such offence at any of their fellow members, but to wait upon Christ, ²⁶in the further proceeding of the church.

²⁶ Matthew 18:15-17; Ephesians 4:2-3

14 As each church, and all the members of it, are bound to ²⁷pray continually for the good and prosperity of all the churches of Christ, in all places, and upon all occasions to further every one within the bounds of their places and callings, in the exercise of their gifts and graces, so the churches, when planted by the providence of God, so as they may enjoy opportunity and advantage for it, ought to hold ²⁸communion among themselves, for their peace, increase of love, and mutual edification.

²⁷ Ephesians 6:18; Psalms 122:6

²⁸ Romans 16:1-2; 3 John 8-10

15 In cases of difficulties or differences, either in point of doctrine or administration, wherein either the churches in general are concerned, or any one church, in their peace, union, and edification; or any member or members of any church are injured, in or by any proceedings in censures not agreeable to truth and order: it is according to the mind of Christ, that many churches holding communion together, do, by their messengers, meet to consider, ²⁹and give their advice in or about that matter in difference, to be reported to all the churches concerned; howbeit these messengers assembled, are not intrusted with any church-power properly so called; or with any jurisdiction over the churches themselves, to exercise any censures either over any churches or persons; or ³⁰to impose their determination on the churches or officers.

²⁹ Acts 15:2,4,6,22-23,25

³⁰ 2 Corinthians 1:24; 1 John 4:1

Chapter XXVII

Of the Communion of Saints

1 All saints that are united to Jesus Christ, their head, by his Spirit, and faith, although they are not made thereby one person with him, have ¹fellowship in his graces, sufferings, death, resurrection, and glory; and, being united to one another in love, they ²have communion in each other's gifts and graces, and are obliged to the performance of such duties, public and private, in an orderly way, ³as do conduce to their mutual good, both in the inward and outward man.

¹ 1 John 1:3; John 1:16; Philemon 3:10; Romans 6:5-6

² Ephesians 4:15-16; 1 Co 12:7; 3:21-23

³ 1 Thessalonians 5:11,14; Romans 1:12; 1 John 3:17-18; Galatians 6:10

2 Saints by profession are bound to maintain an holy fellowship and communion in the worship of God, and in performing such other spiritual services ⁴as tend to their mutual edification; as also in relieving each other in ⁵outward things according to their several abilities, and necessities; which communion, according to the rule of the gospel, though especially to be exercised by them, in the relation wherein they stand, whether in ⁶families, or ⁷churches, yet, as God offereth opportunity, is to be extended to all the household of faith, even all those who in every place call upon the name of the Lord Jesus; nevertheless their communion one with another as saints, doth not take away or ⁸infringe the title or propriety which each man hath in his goods and possessions.

⁴ Hebrews 10:24-25; 3:12-13

⁵ Acts 11:29-30

⁶ Ephesians 6:4

⁷ 1 Corinthians 12:14-27

⁸ Acts 5:4; Ephesians 4:28

Chapter XXVIII

Of Baptism and the Lord's Supper

1 Baptism and the Lord's Supper are ordinances of positive and sovereign institution, appointed by the Lord Jesus, the only lawgiver, to be continued in his church ¹to the end of the world.

¹ Matthew 28:19-20; 1 Corinthians 11:26

2 These holy appointments are to be administered by those only who are qualified and thereunto called, according ²to the commission of Christ.

² Matthew 28:19; 1 Corinthians 4:1

Chapter XXIX

Of Baptism

1 Baptism is an ordinance of the New Testament, ordained by Jesus Christ, to be unto the party baptized, a sign of his fellowship with him, in his death¹ and resurrection; of his being engrafted into him; of ²remission of sins; and of ³giving up into God, through Jesus Christ, to live and walk in newness of life.

¹ Romans 6:3-5; Colossians 2:12; Galatians 3:27

² Mark 1:4; Acts 22:16

³ Romans 6:4

2 Those who do actually profess ⁴repentance towards God, faith in, and obedience to, our Lord Jesus Christ, are the only proper subjects of this ordinance.

⁴ Mark 16:16; Acts 8:36-37; 2:41; 8:12; 18:8

3 The outward element to be used in this ordinance ⁵is water, wherein the party is to be baptized, in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit.

⁵ Matthew 28:19-20; Acts 8:38

4 Immersion, or dipping of the person ⁶in water, is necessary to the due administration of this ordinance.

⁶ Matthew 3:16; John 3:23

Chapter XXX

Of the Lord's Supper

1 The supper of the Lord Jesus was instituted by him the same night wherein he was betrayed, to be observed in his churches, unto the end of the world, for the perpetual remembrance, and shewing forth the sacrifice of himself in his death, ¹confirmation of the faith of believers in all the benefits thereof, their spiritual nourishment, and growth in him, their further engagement in and to all duties which they owe to him; ²and to be a bond and pledge of their communion with him, and with each other.

¹ 1 Corinthians 11:23-26

² 1 Corinthians 10:16-17, 21

2 In this ordinance Christ is not offered up to his Father, nor any real sacrifice made at all for remission of sin of the quick or dead, but only a memorial of that ³one offering up of himself by himself upon the cross, once for all; and a spiritual oblation of all ⁴possible praise unto God for the same. So that the popish sacrifice of the mass, as they call it, is most abominable, injurious to Christ's own sacrifice the alone propitiation for all the sins of the elect.

³ Hebrews 9:25-26, 28

⁴ 1 Corinthians 11:24; Matthew 26:26-27

3 The Lord Jesus hath, in this ordinance, appointed his ministers to pray, and bless the elements of bread and wine, and thereby to set them apart from a common to a holy use, and to take and break the bread; to take the cup, ⁵and, they communicating also themselves, to give both to the communicants.

⁵ 1 Corinthians 11:23-26, etc.

4 The denial of the cup to the people, worshipping the elements, the lifting them up, or carrying them about for adoration, and reserving them for any pretended religious use, ⁶are all contrary to the nature of this ordinance, and to the institution of Christ.

⁶ Matthew 26:26-28; 15:9; Exodus 20:4-5

5 The outward elements in this ordinance, duly set apart to the use ordained by Christ, have such relation to him crucified, as that truly, although in terms used figuratively, they are sometimes called by the names of the things they represent, to wit, the ⁷body and blood of Christ, albeit, in substance and nature, they still remain truly and only ⁸bread and wine, as they were before.

⁷ 1 Corinthians 11:27

⁸ 1 Corinthians 11:26,28

6 That doctrine which maintains a change of the substance of bread and wine, into the substance of Christ's body and blood, commonly called transubstantiation, by consecration of a priest, or by any other way, is repugnant not to Scripture ⁹alone, but even to common sense and reason, overthroweth the ¹⁰nature of the ordinance, and hath been, and is, the cause of manifold superstitions, yea, of gross idolatries.

⁹ Acts 3:21; Luke 24:6,39

¹⁰ 1 Corinthians 11:24-25

7 Worthy receivers, outwardly partaking of the visible elements in this ordinance, do then also inwardly by faith, really and indeed, yet not carnally and corporally, but spiritually receive, and feed upon Christ crucified, ¹¹and all the benefits of his death; the body and blood of Christ being then not corporally or carnally, but spiritually present to the faith of believers in that ordinance, as the elements themselves are to their outward senses.

¹¹ 1 Corinthians 10:16; 11:23-26

8 All ignorant and ungodly persons, as they are unfit to enjoy communion ¹²with Christ, so are they unworthy of the Lord's table, and cannot, without great sin against him, while they remain such, partake of these holy mysteries, ¹³or be admitted thereunto; yea, whosoever shall receive unworthily, are guilty of the body and blood of the Lord, eating and drinking judgment to themselves.

¹² 2 Corinthians 6:14-15

¹³ 1 Corinthians 11:29; Matthew 7:6

Chapter XXXI

Of the State of Man after Death and Of the Resurrection of the Dead

1 The bodies of men after death return to dust, ¹and see corruption; but their souls, which neither die nor sleep, having an immortal subsistence, immediately ²return to God who gave them. The souls of the righteous being then made perfect in holiness, are received into paradise, where they are with Christ, and behold the face of God in light ³and glory, waiting for the full redemption of their bodies; and the souls of the wicked are cast into hell; where they remain in torment and utter darkness, reserved to ⁴the judgment of the great day; besides these two places, for souls separated from their bodies, the Scripture acknowledgeth none.

¹ Genesis 3:19; Acts 13:36

² Ecclesiastes 12:7

³ Luke 23:43; 2 Corinthians 5:1,6,8; Philemon 1:23; Hebrews 12:3

⁴ Jude 1:6-7; 1 Peter 3:19; Luke 16:23-24

2 At the last day, such of the saints as are found alive, shall not sleep, but be ⁵changed; and all the dead shall be raised up with the selfsame bodies, and ⁶none other; although with different ⁷qualities, which shall be united again to their souls forever.

⁵ 1 Corinthians 15:51-52; 1 Thessalonians 4:17

⁶ Job 19:26-27

⁷ 1 Corinthians 15:42-43

3 The bodies of the unjust shall, by the power of Christ, be raised to dishonour; the bodies of the just, by his Spirit, unto honour, ⁸and be made conformable to his own glorious body.

⁸ Acts 24:15; John 5:28-29; Philemon 3:21

Chapter XXXII

Of the Last Judgment

1 God hath appointed a day wherein he will judge the world in righteousness, by ¹Jesus Christ; to whom all power and judgment is given of the Father; in which day, not only the ²apostate angels shall be judged, but likewise all persons that have lived upon the earth shall appear before the tribunal of Christ, ³to give an account of their thoughts, words, and deeds, and to receive according to what they have done in the body, whether good or evil.

¹ Acts 17:31; John 5:22,27

² 1 Corinthians 6:3; Jude 1:6

³ 2 Corinthians 5:10; Ecclesiastes 12:14; Matthew 12:36; Romans 14:10,12; Matthew 25:32-46

2 The end of God's appointing this day, is for the manifestation of the glory of his mercy, in the eternal salvation of the elect; ⁴and of his justice, in the eternal damnation of the reprobate, who are wicked and disobedient; for then shall the righteous go into everlasting life, and receive that fulness of joy and glory with everlasting rewards, in the presence ⁵of the Lord; but the wicked, who know not God, and obey not the gospel of Jesus Christ, shall be cast aside into everlasting torments, and ⁶punished with everlasting destruction, from the presence of the Lord, and from the glory of his power.

⁴ Romans 9:22-23

⁵ Matthew 25:21,34; 2 Timothy 4:8

⁶ Matthew 25:46; Mark 9:48; 2 Thessalonians 1:7-10

3 As Christ would have us to be certainly persuaded that there shall be a day of judgment, both ⁷to deter all men from sin, and for the greater ⁸consolation of the godly in their adversity, so will he have the day unknown to men, that they may shake off all carnal security, and be always watchful, because they know not at what hour the ⁹Lord will come, and may ever be prepared to say, ¹⁰Come Lord Jesus; come quickly. Amen.

⁷ 2 Corinthians 5:10-11

⁸ 2 Thessalonians 1:5-7

⁹ Mark 13:35-37; Luke 12:35-40

¹⁰ Revelation 22:20

We, the ministers and messengers of, and concerned for, upwards of one hundred baptized congregations in England and Wales (denying Arminianism 12), being met together in London, from the third of the seventh month to the eleventh of the same, 1689, to consider of some things that might be for the glory of God, and the good of these congregations, have thought meet (for the satisfaction of all other Christians that differ from us in the point of baptism) to recommend to their perusal the confession of our faith, which confession we own as containing the doctrine of our faith and practice, and do desire that the members of our churches respectively do furnish themselves therewith,

12 Arminianism – system of doctrine taught by Jacobus Arminius (1560-1609), Dutch theologian. He rejected the Reformers' understanding of salvation by God's sovereign election, teaching instead that God's election of individuals was based on His foreknowledge of their accepting or rejecting Christ by their own free will.

Hanserd Knollys	Pastor	Broken Wharf London
William Kiffin	Pastor	Devonshire-square London
John Harris	Pastor	Joiner's Hall London
William Collins	Pastor	Petty France London
Hercules Collins	Pastor	Wapping London
Robert Steed	Pastor	Broken Wharf London
Leonard Harrison	Pastor	Limehouse London
George Barret	Pastor	Mile End Green London
Isaac Lamb	Pastor	Pennington-street London
Richard Adams	Minister	Shad Thames Southwark
Benjamin Keach	Pastor	Horse-lie-down Southwark
Andrew Gifford	Pastor	Bristol, Fryars Som. & Glouc.
Thomas Vaux	Pastor	Broadmead Som. & Glouc.
Thomas Winnel	Pastor	Taunton Som. & Glouc.
James Hitt	Preacher	Dalwood Dorset
Richard Tidmarsh	Minister	Oxford City Osen
William Facey	Pastor	Reading Berks
Samuel Buttall	Minister	Plymouth Devon
Christopher Price	Minister	Abergavenny Monmouth
Daniel Finch	Minister	Kingsworth Herts
John Ball	Minister	Tiverton Devon
Edmond White	Pastor	Evershall Bedford
William Pritchard	Pastor	Blaenau Monmouth
Paul Fruin	Minister	Warwick Warwick
Richard Ring	Pastor	Southampton Hants
John Tompkins	Minister	Abingdon Berks
Toby Willes	Pastor	Bridewater Somerset
John Carter		Steventon Bedford
James Webb		Devizes Wilts.
Richard Sutton	Pastor	Tring Herts
Robert Knight	Pastor	Stukeley Bucks
Edward Price	Pastor	Hereford-City Hereford
William Phipps	Pastor	Exon Devon
William Hawkins	Pastor	Dimmock Gloucester
Samuel Ewer	Pastor	Hemstead Herts
Edward Man	Pastor	Houndsditch London
Charles Archer	Pastor	Hick-Norton Oxon

In the name of and on the behalf of the whole assembly.